CACTUS Week 8: Reproduce and Present



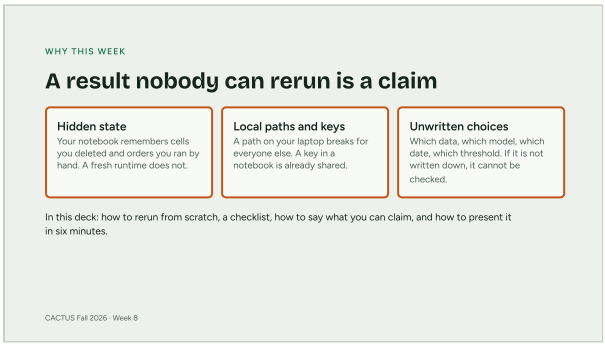
Slide 1

TIME 1 min (0:00)

SAY This is the introduction to the reproducibility exercise you do before presentation day. About 20 minutes on how to make a project rerunnable and presentable. On presentation day itself there are only presentations.

DO Post the course site link and the rerun report link. Say the plan: share your repository link, a partner reruns your notebook and sends you a rerun report, you fix what broke, and then you present.

NOTE Present this at the end of Week 7 Session 2 (about 20 minutes), or share the slides and the script for reading on your own.



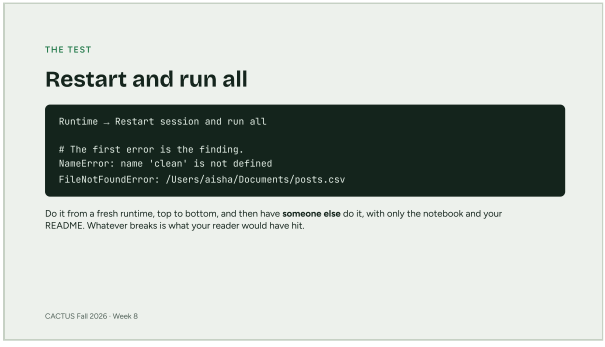
Slide 2

TIME 3 min (0:01 to 0:04)

SAY A result you cannot rerun is a claim, not a finding. There are three usual reasons. Hidden state: your notebook remembers cells you deleted and orders you ran by hand. Local paths and keys: a path on your laptop breaks for everyone else, and a key in a notebook is already shared. Unwritten choices: which data, which model, which date, which threshold.

DO Read the three cards. Ask: who has ever opened an old notebook and found it would not run? Take two hands.

WATCH FOR People who hear this as a criticism. Say that every notebook has this problem until you test it.



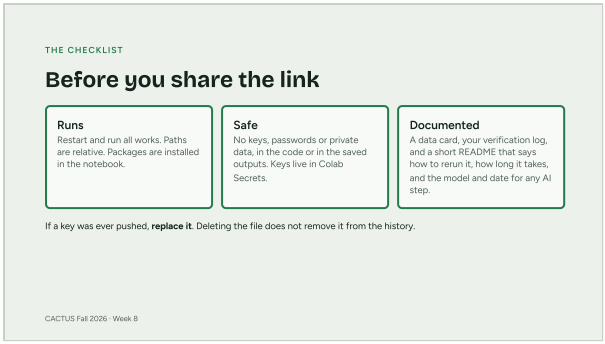
Slide 3

TIME 4 min (0:04 to 0:08)

SAY The test is simple. In Colab, Runtime, Restart session and run all. The first error is the finding. Then have someone else do it, with only the notebook and the README. Whatever breaks for them would have broken for any reader.

DO (live demo, optional) open a small notebook with one deliberately broken cell, restart and run all, and read the first error aloud. Show how the error points at the cause. If you do not have one ready, describe the two example errors on the slide.

IF ASKED about a very long notebook run it on a small sample first, then the full thing.



Slide 4

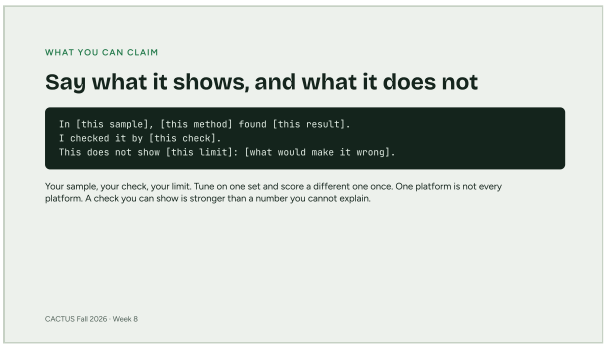
TIME 4 min (0:08 to 0:12)

SAY Before you share a link: it runs (restart and run all works, paths are relative, packages are installed in the notebook); it is safe (no keys or private data, in the code or in the saved outputs, and keys live in Colab Secrets); and it is documented (a data card, your verification log, and a short README that says how to rerun it, how long it takes, and the model and date for any AI step).

DO Say the key point loudly: if a key was ever pushed, replace it. Deleting the file does not remove it from the history.

IF ASKED about ethics or data sharing say that is a good question for your supervisor, and Kokil is the ethics contact for CACTUS.

WATCH FOR Saved outputs. People check the code and forget that printed tables can contain names or handles.



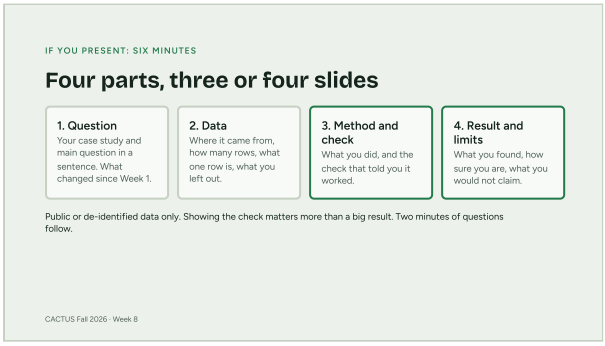
Slide 5

TIME 4 min (0:12 to 0:16)

SAY Say what your result shows and what it does not. The frame on the slide: in this sample, this method found this; I checked it by this; this does not show that, and here is what would make it wrong. Tune on one set and score a different one once. One platform is not every platform. A check you can show is stronger than a number you cannot explain.

DO Ask the room to say one limit of their own project aloud. Take two.

WATCH FOR Claims that go beyond the sample, and 'proves' or 'causes'.



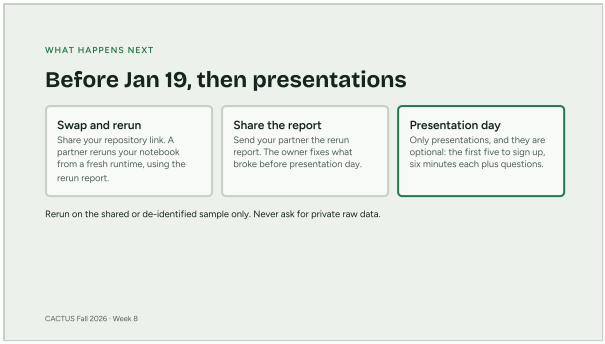
Slide 6

TIME 3 min (0:16 to 0:19)

SAY Presenting is optional, and there are five places, first come first served. If you present, it is six minutes, plus two for questions. Four parts: the question, the data, the method and the check, and the result and its limits. Three or four slides. Public or de-identified data only. The check matters more than a big result.

DO Say what we look for: a clear question, data described honestly, at least one check you can show, claims that match the evidence, and a notebook someone else could rerun. Say the Desk will give a warning at five minutes.

WATCH FOR People planning too much. Say that one clear idea beats five.

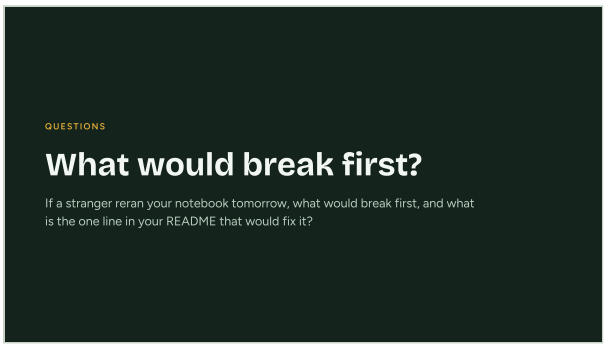


Slide 7

TIME 1 min (0:19 to 0:20)

SAY Before presentation day: share your repository link, and a partner reruns your notebook from a fresh runtime, using the rerun report. Write down what broke and what you could not follow, and the owner fixes it. On the day itself, only presentations, and they are optional: five places, first come first served.

DO Say the pairs, the dates (tentative: links shared by Jan 15, reports back by Jan 17, fixes by Jan 18) and post the link to the rerun report template. Say the rule: partners rerun on the shared or de-identified sample only, never on private raw data.



Slide 8

TIME remaining

SAY If a stranger reran your notebook tomorrow, what would break first, and what is the one line in your README that would fix it?

DO Take questions. If you do not know an answer, say so and write it down.
